

LKA Invoices

Managing users & admin accounts · Firebase clean-up · Portal limits

Lingeshwar Kaparathi & Associates · Live app: lingeshwarca-invoice.netlify.app · Firebase project: ca-invoice-app · Prepared October 2026

1. Roles: who can do what

Action	STAFF	ADMIN
Create, edit and issue invoices; view / download / send PDFs; record payments	Yes	Yes
Add, edit and delete clients	Yes	Yes
Delete draft invoices	Yes	Yes
Cancel or delete numbered invoices (Issued / Paid / Cancelled)	No	Yes
Settings: firm details, bank / UPI, GST, services, signature, branding	No	Yes
Restart invoice numbering at 0001; Backup	No	Yes
Add users, change roles, disable / enable / delete users	No	Yes

Always keep two ADMIN accounts. An admin cannot change, disable or delete their own account. With only one admin, losing that account means nobody can manage users (see section 4 for recovery).

2. Managing users inside the portal (recommended)

Everything is in **Settings** → **Users** (visible to ADMINS only). The portal method is preferred because it cleans up everything in one click.

2.1 Give someone access

1. Under **Give someone access**, type the person's **Google email** (Gmail or Google Workspace address).
2. Choose the role, **STAFF** or **ADMIN**, and click **Give access**.
3. They appear under **Waiting to sign in**.
4. Send them the site link. They click **Sign in with Google** using that same email, and they are let in automatically.
5. They then move to **People with access**, which shows "Active now" or when they were last active.

To cancel an invite before it is used, click **Remove** next to the email under *Waiting to sign in*.

2.2 Change someone's role

1. Find the person under **People with access**.
2. Click **Make ADMIN** or **Make STAFF** and confirm.
3. They are signed out and get the new role when they sign in again.

2.3 Block someone temporarily

For leave, a lost phone or a suspected misuse:

1. Click **Disable** on their row and confirm. They are signed out at once and cannot sign in.
2. To restore access, click **Enable**. Nothing is lost.

2.4 Delete someone permanently

For example, when a person leaves the firm:

1. Click **Delete** on their row.
2. Type **DELETE** in the box and click **Delete user**.

This removes:

- their sign-in account and access
- any pending invite
- their private tasks, events, notes and links

Invoices and clients they created are kept. To give them access again later, add their email again as in 2.1.

3. Managing users in the Firebase console (backup method)

Use this only if the portal is not available, or to double-check. Open <https://console.firebase.google.com> and select the project **ca-invoice-app**.

3.1 Find a user

1. In the left menu, open **Build** → **Authentication** → **Users**.
2. Each row shows:
 - the email
 - the sign-in method (Google or email)
 - the **User UID**, a long code you will need below

3.2 Disable a user (temporary)

1. Click  at the end of the user's row, then **Disable account**.
2. To undo, use **Enable account** from the same menu.
3. Also click **Disable** in the portal, so the Users page shows the correct status.

3.3 Delete a user completely: do all four steps

1. **Authentication** → **Users**:

- Note the person's **User UID**.
- Click , then **Delete account**, and confirm. They can no longer sign in.

2. **Build** → **Firestore Database** → **Data**:

- Open the `users` collection and find the document whose name equals that UID.
- Use the  menu at the top of the document to choose **Delete document**.
- Without this step, they still appear on the portal's Users page.

3. In the `invites` collection, if a document named with their email exists, delete it. Otherwise they could sign in again and regain access.

4. Optional: in the `tasks`, `events`, `notes` and `links` collections, delete documents whose `ownerUid` equals that UID.

3.4 What the console cannot do

- **Change roles.** ADMIN / STAFF is stored in a protected place the console does not show. Change roles only in the portal (2.2).
- **Give access by itself.** If someone signs in with Google without being on the Users list, Firebase creates a sign-in account for them. They only see "No access yet", and these stray accounts are safe to delete in Authentication.

Never delete these Firestore collections or documents in the console:

- `counters` : invoice numbering
- `settings` : firm details
- `system` : setup lock
- `auditLog` : invoice history

Delete invoices only in the portal (Invoices page), so the history log records it.

4. If all admin access is lost

1. In Netlify, open **Site configuration** → **Environment variables**:

- Add `SETUP_CODE` with a new secret of 12 or more characters.
- Go to **Deploys** → **Trigger deploy** → **Deploy site**.

2. In the Firebase console, open **Firestore Database** → **Data** → **system** and delete the document **bootstrap**.

3. Sign in to the portal with Google. On the "No access yet" screen, enter the setup code. You become ADMIN.

4. Delete `SETUP_CODE` from Netlify again and redeploy.

Step 3 works only when **no** admin exists at all. If an admin account still exists but nobody can use it, first delete that account as described in 3.3. Keeping two admins avoids this situation entirely.

5. Good practice checklist

- Delete `SETUP_CODE` from Netlify once the first admin is set up, then redeploy.
- Keep two ADMIN accounts.
- Delete users who leave the firm on their last day (2.4). Use Disable for temporary blocks.
- Once a month, take a backup in **Settings** → **Backup** and keep the file safe (Google Drive or a USB drive). The free Firebase plan has no automatic backups.
- Sign out on shared computers. The portal also signs you out automatically after 30 minutes of inactivity.
- Share only invoice PDFs with clients, never the portal link or your login.

6. Limits for clients and invoices

The portal has no fixed limit on how many clients or invoices it stores. The practical limits come from the invoice number format and Firebase's free (Spark) plan.

Limit	Value	What it means
Invoices per financial year	9,999	Numbers have 4 digits (LKA/2026-27/ 0001 to 9999) and restart every 1 April. That is about 27 invoices a day, every day.
Clients	No app limit	Tens of thousands would still fit.
Service lines per invoice	50	Plus up to 30 reimbursement lines.
Services in the Settings list	100	Each with an optional default price.
Total storage (free plan)	1 GB	One invoice with its history is about 5 KB, so roughly 150,000–200,000 invoices in total: decades of use for a small firm.
Reads per day (free plan)	50,000	Opening the invoice list uses about 25 reads; a busy day uses a few hundred to a couple of thousand.
Writes per day (free plan)	20,000	Creating and issuing an invoice uses about 4–6 writes.
Deletes per day (free plan)	20,000	Matters only for very large "Delete all" actions.

If a daily limit is reached:

- The portal shows an error until the limit resets, at about **1:30 pm IST** each day.
- **There are never any charges.** The free plan simply pauses; it does not bill you, and no card is needed.
- With normal use you will not come close. Only very large one-off jobs could reach a limit, such as a backup or CSV export of thousands of invoices.
- You can check usage in the Firebase console under **Firestore Database** → **Usage**.